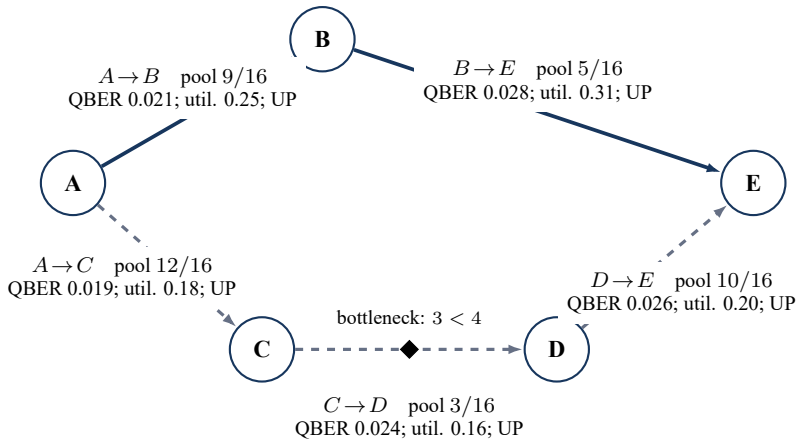


## Link-local trusted-relay pools at one decision instant



**Solid:**  $\mathcal{R}_0 = A \rightarrow B \rightarrow E$  (feasible)      **Dashed:**  $\mathcal{R}_1 = A \rightarrow C \rightarrow D \rightarrow E$  (excluded)

**Request**  $D = 4$  key units  
on every traversed link

**1. Hard eligibility** Check  
each link-local pool and status  
 $v_0 = 1$ ;  $v_1 = 0$  because  $K_{CD} = 3$

**2. Soft preference** Compare profiles  
only among candidates with  $v_i = 1$   
Current admissible set:  $\{\mathcal{R}_0\}$

If  $K_{CD}$  reaches 7 and the other  
hard checks remain valid,  $v_0 =$   
 $v_1 = 1$  and profile-based preference  
may choose between both routes.